

Why nobody read past page three.

What we are asking you to decide

Three decisions. Everything after this page is evidence for them. If you read nothing else, this page is enough to act on.

1. Cut the quarterly report to eight pages

Recommended. Readership drops off sharply after page three and the remaining 52 pages are consumed by four people, all of whom have the raw data anyway.

2. Move the customer panel from annual to twice-yearly

Recommended. The annual cycle means findings arrive an average of seven months after the behaviour they describe.

3. Stop the monthly sentiment tracker

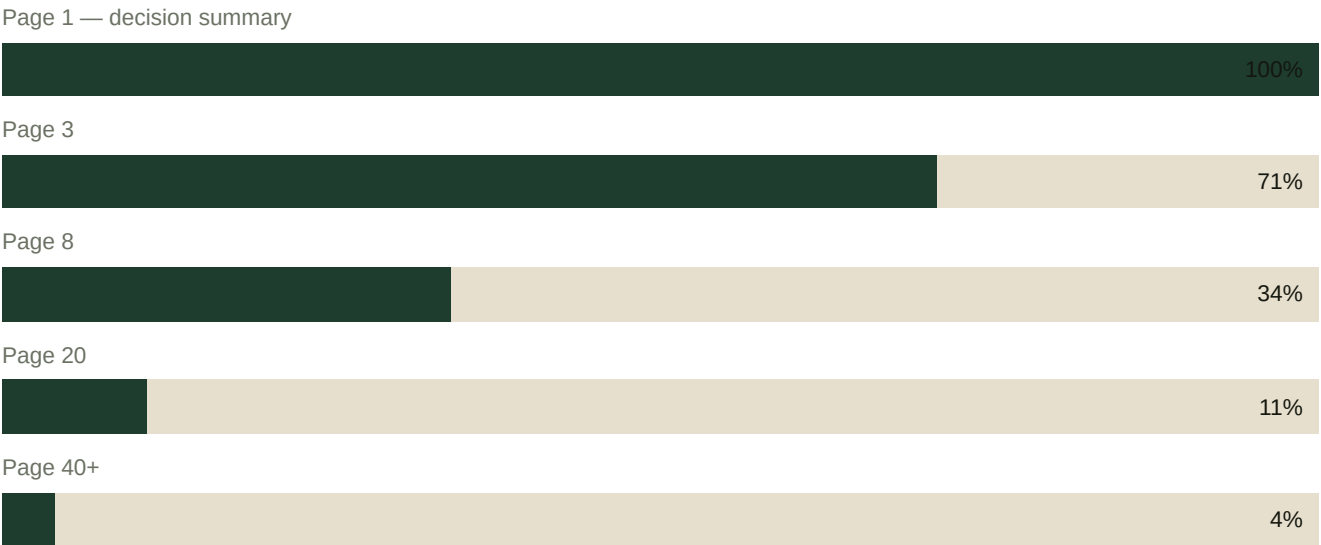
Recommended, with one objection noted on page 4. It has not changed a decision in two years.

SO WHAT

Reporting effort is currently spent in inverse proportion to how the output is used. These three changes free roughly eleven working days a quarter.

How far people actually read

Scroll depth on the digital edition, last four issues, 212 readers.



SO WHAT

Anything that must be acted on has to appear before page three. The long tail is an archive, and archives belong in an appendix nobody has to scroll past.

Chart standard applied: one idea per chart, labelled directly, no legend, no second axis.

Where the effort goes

Output	Days per quarter	Readers
Quarterly report, pages 1–8	4	212
Quarterly report, pages 9–60	11	4
Monthly sentiment tracker	6	9
Customer panel write-up	5	31

SO WHAT

Eleven of the twenty-six days produce something four people read. Those four already receive the underlying dataset.

The section template we now use

- **Finding** — one sentence, no hedging.
- **Evidence** — one chart or one table, never both.
- **So what** — a standing line on every section. If it can't be written, the section is cut.
- **Confidence** — high, medium or low, stated plainly.

The case against each recommendation

Against cutting to eight pages

The long version is the audit trail. Counter: move it to a linked appendix, versioned, not printed.

Against twice-yearly panels

Recruitment cost roughly doubles. Counter: smaller panels, same total spend, accepted wider error bars.

Against stopping the sentiment tracker

Two directors use it as an early-warning signal and would lose a habit rather than a report. This is the weakest of the three recommendations and we would not contest a decision to keep it for another two quarters — with an agreed test: if it changes no decision by March, it stops automatically.

SO WHAT

Recommendation three is the one to argue about. One and two are not close calls.

Everything above, on a single sheet

Generated from the same source content, so it can never drift from the full report.

Decision	Recommendation	Confidence
Report length	Cut to 8 pages + appendix	High
Panel frequency	Twice yearly, smaller	High
Sentiment tracker	Stop, or test to March	Medium

METHOD, STATED PLAINLY

Scroll data from 212 readers over four issues; effort estimates from team timesheets; readership counts from distribution logs. No modelling, no projections. Where a number is an estimate it is marked as one.

Sample document produced by Easyworld to demonstrate a report system. The organisation, the figures and the readers are invented for illustration and should not be quoted.